

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

GOP unity on menu at the White House

President, senators have lunch, signal no budget compromise

By Lisa Mascaro, Mary Clare Jalonick and Seung Min Kim
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Head Start programs for preschoolers nationwide are scrambling for federal funds. The federal agency tasked with overseeing the U.S. nuclear stockpile has begun furloughing its 1,400 employees. Thousands more federal workers are going without paychecks.

But as President Donald Trump welcomed Republican senators for lunch in the newly renovated Rose Garden Club — with construction underway on the new White House ballroom — he portrayed a different vision of America as a unified GOP refuses to yield to Democratic demands for health care funds, and the government shutdown drags on.

“We have the hottest country anywhere in the world, which tells you about leadership,” Trump said in opening remarks, extolling the renovations underway as senators took their seats in the newly paved over garden-turned patio.

It was a festive atmosphere under crisp but sunny autumn skies as senators settled in for cheeseburgers, fries and chocolates, and Trump’s favored songs — “YMCA” and “You Can’t Always Get What You Want” — played over the new sound system.

And while Trump said the shutdown must come to an end — and suggested maybe Smithsonian museums could reopen — he signaled no compromise with Democrats over the expiring health care funds.

“From the beginning, our message has been very simple, we will not be extorted on this crazy plot of theirs,” Trump said.

As the government shutdown enters its fourth week — on track to become among the longest in U.S. history — millions of Americans are bracing for health care sticker shock while others are feeling the financial hit. Economists have warned that the federal closure, leaving most of the 2.4 million-strong federal workforce without pay, will shave economic growth by 0.1 to 0.2 percentage points per week.

There are few signs of any end to the stalemate. Democratic leaders Sen. Chuck Schumer and Rep. Hakeem Jeffries reached out to the White House on Tuesday, seeking a meeting with Trump before the president departs for his next overseas trip, to Asia.

“We urged him to meet with us,” Schumer said. “We said we’ll set up an appointment with him anytime, anyplace before he leaves.”

But Republicans, departing the White House with gifts of Trump caps and medallions, said there is nothing to negotiate with Democrats over the health care funds until the government reopens.

“People keep saying ‘negotiate’ — negotiate what?” Senate Majority Leader John Thune said

Turn to Shutdown, Page 2

Protesters in court amid criticism of police tactics



A protester is detained after a tussle between protesters and members of the Illinois State Police and Cook County sheriff’s office a block from the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview on Oct. 9. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Some argue local law enforcement used excessive force, raised number of arrests

By Madeline Buckley and Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

About 3 miles from the west suburban immigration processing center that has become a flashpoint for protests in recent weeks, a Cook County judge sat across from a woman who had been arrested there and ordered her to stay away from the Broadview facility.

“I am not stifling you of your right to protest,” said Judge Ralph Meczyk, adding that she can still exercise her First Amendment rights elsewhere.

The 28-year-old woman is among the first wave of protest-

ers arrested by state or local agencies to appear in county court after the state stepped in earlier this month in an attempt to help control the large and chaotic demonstrations that have seen federal agents deploy tear gas and other measures.

So far, Illinois State Police, the Cook County sheriff’s office and the Broadview Police Department have arrested around 70 people at the protests, which have happened periodically since the September launch of “Operation Midwest Blitz.”

The majority of the initial charges have been for resisting

Turn to Protesters, Page 4



Ofelia Torres, 16, left, and her mother, Sandibell Hidalgo, 40, at their home on Monday in Chicago. Torres’ father and Hidalgo’s husband, Ruben Maldonado, was taken by Immigration and Customs Enforcement officers over the weekend. Torres was diagnosed with rhabdomyosarcoma cancer in December 2024. ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

‘HE BELONGS WITH HER’

ICE arrests Chicago man whose teenage daughter is fighting Stage 4 cancer

By Gregory Royal Pratt
Chicago Tribune

Ofelia Torres has spent almost every day of the past month at Lurie Children’s Hospital, where the 16-year-old Lake View High School student is fighting cancer.

After a tough few weeks where the disease spread through her body and doctors inserted a drain in her abdomen to relieve fluid, the Torres family worked with her oncologist to arrange a short getaway over the weekend,

where she and three of her closest friends could enjoy a Saturday of simple pleasures and normalcy before a scheduled return to the hospital and chemotherapy.

The girls were getting their nails done as Ofelia’s father, Ruben Torres Maldonado, was at work.

Hours later, he called his wife Sandibell Hidalgo from a number that came up on caller ID as “prison/jail.”

“It’s me,” he said. “They got me.”

In that moment, the Torres family experienced the pain of separation gripping hundreds of immigrant families across Chicago and the suburbs since Donald Trump’s administration last month launched “Operation Midway Blitz,” the president’s aggressive deportation plan.

Now they’re fighting cancer and the United States government. Their attorney, Kalman Resnick, filed a petition in federal court to have him freed while Torres’ deportation case

proceeds.

His family needs him, they say.

Ruben Torres and Sandibell Hidalgo are parents of not only Ofelia, but also a 4-year-old son, Nathan. The father, a 40-year-old painter and home renovator, is the primary breadwinner in a household with carefully balanced child care responsibilities in their Portage Park bungalow. The mother often sleeps at the hospital while he takes care

Turn to Father, Page 4

Republican race for governor already spiraling downward

Candidate wouldn’t denounce operatives tied to fake news site

By Rick Pearson and Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

The devolution of Illinois’ Republican Party continued Tuesday as a candidate for governor refused to denounce two political operatives tied to a right-wing fake newspaper website that published a story contain-

ing an internet link detailing salacious allegations against a rival, while a new candidate emerged with a controversial background as a gambling mogul.

At a brief news conference, GOP governor candidate Ted Dabrowski refused to discuss the public disclosure of a years-old draft harassment complaint involving rival Darren Bailey and his 2022 campaign. The allegations, stemming from Bailey’s failed 2022 bid for governor, were

Turn to Republican, Page 11



Republican gubernatorial candidate Ted Dabrowski talks with media on Tuesday outside Bally’s Casino in Chicago. ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE

INSIDE

Bulls’ mission this year: Start off fast

The last three seasons, the Bulls have stumbled early. They look to turn that around this year, but injuries and a tough schedule won’t help. **Chicago Sports**

100% dedication to women’s sports

Babe’s Sports Bar opened Sept. 27 in Logan Square, the first and only bar in Chicago to show only women’s sports. **Food & Health**

